Joe Karlsson

Principal Developer Marketing Engineer

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I run developer marketing for Connect AI, CData's MCP platform that connects AI agents to live enterprise data. Before that I spent about 15 years writing software, teaching it, and explaining it: front-end tech lead at Best Buy, bootcamp instructor in Honolulu, and developer relations at MongoDB, SingleStore, Tinybird, and CloudQuery. So far that's 100+ talks, including a TEDx talk.

EXPERIENCE

Principal Developer Marketing Engineer

2026 – Present

CData · Remote

MCP · AI Agents · SQL · REST APIs · SEO · Python

- Run developer marketing for Connect AI, CData's managed MCP platform that connects AI agents to live enterprise data, and own developer growth end to end
- Own the developer growth engine: technical docs, content, SEO and AEO, and how the platform is positioned to the engineers building on it
- Grow the organic developer adoption already forming around Connect AI
- Work with Product, Engineering, and Docs to keep the developer experience tight and make CData the obvious choice for connecting AI agents to enterprise data
- Build the demos, guides, and content that show developers how to solve their actual problem

Head of Developer Relations

2024 – 2026

CloudQuery (now env0) · Remote

GCP · AWS · Azure · ClickHouse · Python · SQL

- Built the Developer Relations function from scratch and ran all of it: content, community, docs, events, and video. Also owned the marketing site, docs, and developer hub, from the first Google result to trial activation
- Grew organic traffic 4x in under 3 months (about 1,350 to 5,600+ visitors a week). 426 keywords reached the top 10, including "cloud governance framework" (11 to 2) and "IT asset management" (43 to 7), and two target keywords hit #1
- Weekly search impressions reached 4.9x the previous all-time high, and trial signups rose 61% during the same push
- Rewrote the docs end to end: Quickstart completions went from zero to 25 a week, docs traffic grew 302%, and docs became a measurable activation channel
- Monthly MQLs hit 239% of target. Organic readers converted to trials and closed deals with no paid touchpoints
- Built a weekly audit that combined Search Console, Ahrefs, Plausible, and HubSpot, so every fix shipped as a tracked PR and I could tell which change moved which page
- Built the marketing team's Claude Code skills repo, which became shared internal tooling for both the CloudQuery and env0 brands, plus AI automations that produce sales one-pagers, discovery decks, and pitch slides
- Published 80+ technical posts on cloud security, IaC, and data engineering, ran a webinar series and the YouTube channel, and spoke at conferences
- Attended daily engineering standups and merged 480+ PRs into production
- After the merger with env0, ran the same content playbook on env0.com: organic traffic up 106% in 3 weeks

Senior Developer Advocate

2023 – 2024

Tinybird · Remote

SQL · ClickHouse · BigQuery · Kafka · Snowflake · Redshift · Python · GCP · AWS

- Built custom demos on prospects' own stacks for the Sales team, showing exactly where Tinybird fit their architecture
- Built proofs of concept, including a fraud detection system on GCP, BigQuery, and Kafka (33% fewer fraudulent transactions) and a BigQuery IoT optimization for a trucking company (40% lower compute cost, 30% faster data retrieval)
- Made technical content, videos, webinars, and workshops on real-time analytics for a developer audience
- Built community through workshops, online forums, and conference talks

Senior Developer Advocate

2021 – 2023

SingleStore · Remote

SQL · MySQL · Go · Node.js

- Ran content and video for developers moving from MySQL and PostgreSQL: tutorials, conference talks, and demos
- Set up co-marketing with cloud and tooling partners: joint content, webinars, and conference activations with their marketing and DevRel teams
- Ran conference presence end to end, from talk submissions and booth plans to the content afterward
- Worked with Engineering, Docs, and Sales to line content up with launches, keep it technically accurate, and support pre-sales

Senior Developer Advocate

2019 – 2021

MongoDB · Remote

JavaScript · Node.js · Python · React · MongoDB · AWS

- Keynoted MongoDB World and ran global conference strategy. When COVID canceled events, I moved the program to Twitch, YouTube, and TikTok
- Grew a 25K+ TikTok following (844K+ likes) and ranked #1 on "10 Must-Follow Developers on TikTok"
- Built demos like an IoT kitty litter box and an IoT digital graffiti board
- Wrote MongoDB's schema design, aggregation, and Atlas guides and videos, published on the MongoDB Developer Hub, The New Stack, and Medium

Front End Technical Lead

2017 – 2019

Best Buy · Minneapolis, MN

JavaScript · Node.js · React · Redux · Express · AWS

- Led a team of 10 engineers, QA, and product that owned Account Home on bestbuy.com, one of the top 3 eCommerce sites in North America (millions of users, thousands of requests per second)
- Led the full redesign and rebuild of Account Home with the UX, product, and backend teams
- Built an NLP chatbot that cut customer support call volume 25%

Full-Stack JavaScript Instructor

2015 – 2017

DevLeague · Honolulu, HI

ES6 · JavaScript · Node.js · React · Angular · PostgreSQL · AWS

- Taught full-stack JavaScript at Hawaii's first web development bootcamp, one of the top 10 coding bootcamps in the world
- Wrote the curriculum for its 12-week courses, led workshops, and mentored students into engineering jobs at local and national companies

SKILLS

LANGUAGES

JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Go, Swift, SQL

AI & AGENTS

MCP Servers, Claude Code (skills, hooks, subagents), AI Agents, LLM APIs, Local Models (whisper.cpp, Ollama), Sales and Content Automation

DATABASES

MongoDB, PostgreSQL, MySQL, ClickHouse, Redis, Elasticsearch, SingleStore

CLOUD & DATA

AWS, GCP, Azure, BigQuery, Snowflake, Kafka, Airflow

INFRASTRUCTURE

Proxmox, OpenTofu, Docker, Linux, Prometheus, Grafana, Home Assistant

FRONTEND

React, Redux, Astro, Tailwind CSS, D3.js, Canvas, WebGL

DEVREL & MARKETING

Technical Writing, Developer Docs, Conference Speaking, Video, Content Strategy, SEO, AEO, Conversion Optimization, Sales Enablement, Marketing Analytics, Community, Webinars

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts in Computer Science

2008 – 2012

Gustavus Adolphus College

GPA: 3.5 · Minors: Art History, Math